

The Guarded Gate of Worship

After twenty-seven years of ministry, and even at that one year overdue, actually four years ago He began dealing with me on the whole next phase of where He wants us all to go.

We have been yelling, "Tulsa is in revival," for some time, calling it saved. Because we are doing that, heaven is free to move not only in the city, but also in preparing us and changing us. We are inviting Him to do all those things.

When I first discovered praying in tongues, the revelation gift, I thought, "It will just reveal everything to me." It says you are edifying yourself and building yourself up on your most holy faith by praying in tongues. I thought that was about it.

But praying in tongues kept dropping me off at a fasting limb. You would pray in tongues and say, "That is enough," and it would drop you off at a fasting limb. You would say, "I am not going to fast," and it would take you around and drop you off again. Praying in tongues does not give me what fasting does, but neither does fasting give me what praying in tongues does.

There were several limbs He dropped us off at. When He got to the worship limb, He brought me up to it and tried to drop me off, but I passed it up for a year. Because I would not quit praying in tongues, heaven was free to bring me back around and drop me off at the worship limb again a year later.

As a matter of fact, when He dropped me off, it was right here on this dove, I think, flat on my back when He was done with me. He was saying things like, "You do not know anything about worship." Then He was giving me detailed direction, not like when He visited me the first time a year earlier. Then He just told me what to do and said I would find out. I said, "Oh, okay. That is good." But I could tell there was something iron-fisted about it a year later.

By the time I entered into the private worship He wanted me to enter into, the Born-Again Trail had been preached for a year or a year and a half.

By then I had found out, in breaking into worship, that I could give Him what an Old Testament saint could not. What has become fascinating in the study of children is the fact that Jesus came under the shadow with something to compare to what happens to you and me when we are born again.

The closest thing He could compare to what happens in your spirit, when you are translated out of darkness into light and receive the nature you received when you were born again, is the birth of a newborn.

In Matthew, when He came to the temple, healed the blind, made the lame walk, and overthrew the tables of the money changers, the children cried, "Hosanna, hosanna," in the temple. It does not say much about the adults. It talks about the children.

When the Pharisees religiously confronted Him, He quoted Psalm 8:

"Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings
thou hast perfected praise."

Little did I know that what He was talking about under the shadow was like His coming back to the temple. When He came back, the church was given the rebirth. Because we now have His nature inside us, praise can be perfected. The children worshiping Him in the temple were a shadow of when you and I enter the kingdom, are born again, and He says, "Now you can give Me what Old Testament saints could not."

Praise can be perfected out of the nature He has given us in our born-again spirit.

What did you find in the temple? He was throwing the money changers out, doing signs and wonders, and the children were worshiping Him. You will find these together more and more: worship, perfected praise, and signs and wonders.

Worship has as much to do with His presence as anything I know. It is a different presence than anything I attained in the twenty-six years leading up to this by praying in tongues.

The children under the shadow were worshiping Him as a type of the innocence we have when we are born again and come into the kingdom. This praise we can now enter into can be perfected because of the fellowship we can have with our Father out of the nature He has given us, the nature that made us partakers of His divine nature.

When I found out this was a limb He had been trying to put on, it opened areas of things I began to see, things I had only dreamed about through the years but would never allow myself to believe were actually possible.

If I looked at things in the natural now, I would vote against myself. But I can guarantee you that I am not looking to the natural.

When I first broke into worship, I finally remembered the sequence of events. I was not through with my seeking time, and I wanted to go back. Basically, I had to come out, but I kept wanting to go back. Every time I lined something up to go back, some once-in-a-lifetime event would take place, and I could not make it back in.

Finally, I made it back enough to worship Him and find out some more things I never knew. One was this: hell has seen people come this way before.

Wednesday night, when I was ministering and got so far out there I could hardly stand myself, somewhere along the line I stopped and saw a lock. It looked like one of those old locks from England's reign, a big jail lock with a monstrous key that went in and unlocked it. I saw that a key was ready to unlock. I do not know who it was related to at the moment because I was flowing from one thing to the next.

But I know this by the Spirit: this limb God is putting on now, the worship limb, the glory, and the revelation of the Father, is one of the most guarded, if not the most guarded, of anything God has ever shown me or that I have ever approached.

It seems like hell is gathered at this gate, holding on to the key. In history, they have seen people come by this way before, and they are not going to let this thing pass without a fight.

The fight never bothered me much. What bothered me was the possibility that maybe I was beating the air, that my fight would never make a difference, that I could be deceived off to where all my energy and strength would be spent in a lifetime on something that would not make a difference.

What is getting me more excited than I can handle is not the fight. What I care about is the path opened to me by revelation, knowing the fight is going to make the difference. I do not care about the fight so long as I know where the path leads. That assurance has dropped into me so strongly that when an anointing comes on me and I open my mouth, no matter what I try to say, this has become so much part of me that nothing else comes out.

It was not that it was that important to me at first. It seemed that it was that important to Him.

For you who catch hold of this and believe what we are teaching, you are going to hit this and that. Do not let it bother you. I would be lying if I told you it did not take a lot of experience gained over twenty-seven years to whip him before I stepped off the path and said, "There must be a better way."

I would be lying if I told you it would not be war. But what if I went somewhere in town and said, "This is it," then sat someplace else and said, "This is it," and all these people are saying, "This is great"? What they call great does not make any difference to me. If this is it, just send me home now. All they are doing is sitting there getting old anyway.

If the key to the gate of your fellowship and revelation of your Father were not so guarded, there would not have been the Dark Ages. The Dark Ages were not something God instigated. The same things the enemy pulled on saints through the generations to turn them back are the things he tries now.

Years ago I had a vision. I saw us rising to a place in a realm, and we were parked there. Then I saw the hosts of hell. How many remember the firebrands and the belt of darkness that surrounded the earth? Nobody seemed able to break through, but the glory was on the other side of it.

I asked, "What is that belt of darkness? The principality and power of the air?"

He said, "No, not exactly. It is your flesh and the ability of the devil to manipulate it."

I saw a few people fight like crazy and stick their hand through it. Their hand would get in the glory, and they would come back and minister and lay hands on people like a firebrand. They would do a little bit.

Then somebody else would stick their mind through it and come back and teach like almost nobody had taught before. That would last for a while.

But then I saw some people fighting like crazy, pressing all the way through until they got saturated in the glory. Then they shot like firebrands back to dark places on the earth and started little kindlings of fire. Raging forest fires began. All of these fires started running into each other until the glory covered the earth as the waters cover the sea, until she was flaming and burning with revival.

Please believe me when I say the revelation of the Father, the glory, and getting to know Him through the worship limb has everything to do with you and me hitting our home run. We will not just sit in church swapping offerings and talking about our cars. There is a place in Him where cities go down. Take a city, and you will get another one. Take enough, and you will get a state. Take a state, and you will get another state.

Am I excited? Yes. Not because I am afraid of the fight. I do not care about the fight. I am excited because I finally know I am on the path that goes there.

The revelation gift, fasting, and all the different things you have been taught have delivered you to this. Now it is time. This next realm is where she begins.

What am I most excited about? That I am His son, and all He has is made available to me. I am excited because I am in transition from seeing it to becoming it.

I wrote this about a year and a half ago. It is not finished. It is only about twelve pages, and you know my letters are usually twenty-eight pages. But I want to show you the progression from what He was saying over a year ago to now.

Brother Tim, if you were to ask me if I had any religion in me, I would tell you no. When I say religion, I am not referring to how Webster would interpret the word. Many of us have adopted a meaning for the word that refers more to forms of godliness that deny the power than to man's practices used in worship of a supreme being.

When it comes to you and me, Tim, we know Jesus Christ is the truth, the life, and the way, and no man can come to the Father but by Him. So Satan has taken his most powerful spirit, the spirit of religion, and attempted to destroy our access to God by convincing and deceiving us into believing things about God that are not true, making us believe God is not who He said He is.

When the spirit of religion can affect your thinking and convince you of what God will or will not do, then we begin to believe things about God that are not true. Things were taught and sown into me that were not necessarily true. They were not total error, but they were not necessarily true either.

Those gray areas keep a person from defining their faith enough to make an all-out run for the finish line, knowing the prize they are going to obtain.

When Paul talked about becoming as one who beats the air, he was not talking about a lack of consecration or zeal. He was talking about a person who can have all the energy for God in the world but spend it running a race not set by God. This is where the spirit of religion is most effective.

First Corinthians 9:24-27 says:

"Know ye not that they which run in a race run all,
but one receiveth the prize?
So run, that ye may obtain.
And every man that striveth for the mastery is temperate in all things.
Now they do it to obtain a corruptible crown;
but we an incorruptible.
I therefore so run, not as uncertainly;
so fight I, not as one that beateth the air:
But I keep under my body,
and bring it into subjection:
lest that by any means,
when I have preached to others,
I myself should be a castaway."

It is here, with this transition, that God was most able to protect me against the spirit of religion. That was because of a wonderful, fearful, reverent, respectful transition from God to God my Father.

Of course I knew with a fair amount of certainty that God was my Father, about as much as anyone who had incorporated into their vocabulary all the right words from hearing and saying the right things about God and the place He holds as our Father.

Jesus taught us to pray, "Our Father which art in heaven." Paul said in Ephesians 5 to give thanks always for all things "to God and the Father" in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ. Paul makes a distinction between God and the place He holds as our Father.

As God, He is sovereign, omnipotent, all-powerful. He is righteousness, immutability, eternal life, absolute judgment, absolute love, omniscience, and omnipresence. But He is also my Father.

The Old Testament saints knew Him as God. They could not know Him as God the Father because they did not have the nature we received from Him when we were born again.

When you let God reveal Himself to you as your Father, that is where your faith is really going to grow. When you hear someone say a person has a good nature, they say that because the person consistently does things a certain way. They do not act out of character, so they are predictable. If

they do act out of character, people say, "That is not like them. Something must have happened."

It is hard to have faith when you are translating verses about God and do not know much about Him as your Father.

God had to step out of His character as the Father and deal with Old Testament saints as God, because they did not have a new nature that made them partakers of His divine nature. They could not know Him as Father.

I saw a video about a bird that adopted a little kitten in the wild. The bird would fly over with a worm in its mouth and feed it to the kitten. They grew up together, and even when the cat was older, the bird still stayed around the cat. When the cat adopted a human family, the bird would wait for the cat to come out of the house every day, and they would go off together.

The reason the story made it to Ripley's Believe It or Not was because the bird and the cat went totally against their natures to be in each other's presence. That is what God had to do when He dealt with Old Testament saints. He had to go totally against His nature to operate in the presence of spiritually dead men who had to be atoned for by animal blood and restrained by law.

They did not have a nature that could fellowship with God, nor did God have a nature that could fellowship with them. God had to go against His own nature to deal with them.

This is why it is so important to come to know God as your Father. When He had to deal with Old Testament saints, He had to step out of His character to do so. That is not who He really is. When you get to know Him as Father, this is who He really is.

God had to restrain Old Testament saints with law because they were spiritually dead and could not stop sinning. They had one nature; He had another. It is not that He did not love them. He did. But His fellowship with them was limited because of their unregenerated natures.

Although He loved them and atoned for them with animal blood, He was very aware of the limitations between Him and them and knew there would never be complete fellowship until they were restored to Him by a nature that made them partakers of His divine nature when they were born again.

Hebrews 10:4 says:

"For it is not possible that the blood of bulls and of goats should take away sins."

A few years ago, I had a silver-gray eastern timber wolf. No one could tell me I did not love Cain. I loved my wolf. He could stand flat-footed on our kitchen floor and eat off the counter next to the kitchen sink without jumping up. He weighed between 130 and 140 pounds and had over a thousand pounds of crushing power per square inch in his jaws.

I know he looked at me as a foolish human when I would jump on him, get him in a headlock, wrap my legs around his chest, and hang on like a leech while he dragged me around the yard. I knew he was just tolerating me when he would lie down patiently and wait for this human-like thing to turn loose of him.

He would always look at me with those yellow wolf eyes while a playful look came over his face. Cain loved me.

I felt like Benedict Arnold when I had to let him go live on a ranch. I could not stand putting him on a chain. The people who took him had previously owned a wolf for seventeen years that died of old age, and the setting was perfect for Cain. I had to let him go.

But no one could tell me I did not love Cain. I did. Our relationship was limited by Cain's nature. I had to put him under law. I had to put him on a chain. I could not change Cain's nature, so I had to restrain him with law. In our relationship, I had to be constantly aware of Cain's nature.

Until God could change man's nature, He had to restrain him. He had to put him under law. As much as I loved Cain and valued his freedom, I had to put him on a chain or he would eat the neighbor's farm animals. Cain could no more live among humans without law than God could live among the spiritually dead saints of the Old Testament without law and the temporary atoning power of animal blood.

I have been born again. I am not restrained by law anymore. In fact, God sent the Holy Spirit to be my Teacher because He has a nature I am also a partaker of. The Holy Spirit's nature is the same as the Father's. He is Godhead.

When I was made a partaker of His divine nature, the Holy Spirit stepped into me. This is what He uses in me to cause me to understand the mind of Christ and the things that can be understood no other way.

Go to John 16. I am trying to make it, and I am not trying for Cain either. Whenever I get onto this, He comes back on me the same way as when He began to visit me. I can stand up under it a whole lot better than I did the first day He visited me, when I wept so hard and so long.

It is a glorious place. Peace. So much I am looking for, I am finding.

How can you testify to those things you have not seen? The carnal mind is enmity. It is the enemy of God. Who is it that discerns Me? Who is it that knows Me? Who is it that understands Me? Who can approach this place of light and understanding that I dwell in?

Hear what I would say. When light comes, darkness gives way. Darkness does not prevail where there is light. I brood over you protectively, and it is My desire as your Father that you approach this light that before times no man has seen. It is a place I dwell in, and even with My finger, My power manifests and devils flee.

There is a place of saturation with Me where a person might know Me. Even though they live and occupy a low place, with Me they can walk in a high place. I bring light in a moment's time to anyone who can receive it. The powers of darkness give way to those who have come to Me in this place and have come to know Me.

Do you not understand that even now the key is turning in the door? Yet many have lost it in this stage and have been turned back. Will you be turned back?

As My light invades darkness, I cause the powers of darkness to recede as the water receded off the earth in Noah's day. Cities are enveloped in light, and dark regions and territories give way.

Did I not say all things are possible to him that believes? Is there anything too hard for Me? Why must I say things over and over?

Where are My champions who would lay their lives out on the altar? Where are My Davids who, in their youth, are not afraid of the railings of the giants? Where are those little ones who are small in stature but powerful in prayer, with whom in times past I had to change things?

Think it not strange concerning the things you will see and the things I will do, because I have found a remnant, a small group of people. And no, do not flatter yourselves in thinking that you are it. Light has been coming in many places because the sower has overtaken the reaper in many places, as the walls are laid on the foundation.

But these firebrands are positioning themselves, and a glorious day is at hand. Yes, I am working in your midst. Yes, I have given to you Tulsa.

Sit down for a minute.

Do you remember when I was prophesying? He showed me a man He sent. The man came from Africa. He had been kept in prison, in a hole in the ground with bars on top. When President Bush got in, he got him out. That was his testimony. He said President Bush did something that caused them to release him, and signed something saying they could come to America and we would accommodate them.

This man was on the other side of town, and God told him, "Get in your car and drive across town."

He said, "Where?"

He drove across town, up and down the streets. God kept saying, "No, no, no." Finally he came to this street, and God said, "Turn in here." He turned into the prayer center.

I was leaving. His car was turning in, and I was in my truck. God told me to stop. I stopped, and he looked up and said, "Do you know who the pastor of this church is?"

I said, "Yes. I am him."

He said, "Can I talk to you?"

I said yes. I went back through the office and told him to wait a minute because I had to do something. Then I went and got him.

He said, "I was on the other side of town, and God told me to come over here."

I said, "Why?"

He said, "He wanted to send me with a word to somebody."

You are not in a hole in the ground for years and not learn how to pray. When you get out, you value your freedom. It is not hard to lock yourself up praying. So when he told me a little history, I was prone to believe him.

He said God had sent him, because everywhere he went he said, "This revival is going to pour out," and God said, "No, not here. No, not here. No, not here." Then when he pulled in here, God said, "Here."

I said, "What? Who are you?"

Then he told me about being in the hole and Bush getting him out. I said, "He sent you over to tell me that?"

He said, "Yes. He told me you have been fasting and praying."

I said, "How did you know that?"

He said, "God told me."

I numbered how many people there were that year who completed a forty-day fast. It was fourteen or fifteen people. Plus they were meeting every night except Monday, I believe, calling in the lost and calling Tulsa saved. I outlined everything we were doing in fasting and praying.

He said he did not think there was anybody in the city until God sent him over. Then he said, "Thus saith the Lord, you have your prayers answered."

That is the kind of thing you put into your heart. When somebody comes and says, "You are going to have a child, and it is going to be the Son of God," Mary is trying to take that in. To have somebody sent from another nation with that testimony to say those things, that was when I was just beginning to break into worship. I did not know this part of the limb and this part of the Father, but I do now.

Isn't it something? God can look down your timeline. Now He is betting on you. Somebody is going to do it. Somebody here is going to do it. It might as well be you. It has been prophesied. It might as well be you.

He is brooding. He is loaded. He has places of light that cause darkness to recede. The key is in the lock. Yet even at this point, people will abort. But I also remember when I heard Him say in my spirit, "I have given you revival." Then I saw that man's face again and said, "Oh my God. Do You want me to tell them?"

He said, "I do."

Now maybe I can go to John for a minute. John 16:12 says:

"I have yet many things to say unto you,
but ye cannot bear them now."

They would not be able to grasp them. They could understand the words, but they could not bear or grasp it because they were spiritually dead and did not yet have the capacity to understand.

Verse 13 says:

"Howbeit when he, the Spirit of truth, is come,
he will guide you into all truth:
for he shall not speak of himself;
but whatsoever he shall hear, that shall he speak:
and he will shew you things to come."

Verse 14 says:

"He shall glorify me:
for he shall receive of mine,
and shall shew it unto you."

Verse 15 says:

"All things that the Father hath are mine:
therefore said I,
that he shall take of mine,
and shall shew it unto you."

When He said, "All things the Father has are Mine," He was speaking in His humanity, as the Firstborn of the church and the Firstborn of many brethren. All the Father has is Mine, in My standing with Him as the Firstborn. Therefore, the Holy Spirit will take that standing I have with the Father and reveal it to you so you can walk in it too.

The Holy Spirit will not speak of Himself, but He will glorify Jesus. How will He glorify Him? By taking the standing Jesus has with the Father and showing it to us so we can walk in it too.

That is why praying in tongues has been so important through the years. It is a revelation gift. Praying in tongues releases the Holy Spirit to put a collar on you, take a leash, and guide you into all the truth of the standing Jesus has for you.

You should have heard me crying in the early days, breaking into worship. He was revealing all this at the same time.

I said, "Holy Spirit, aren't You supposed to glorify Jesus? Aren't You supposed to reveal the standing He has with me before the Father? Holy Spirit, You have been sent to glorify Him. You cannot even speak of Yourself. You have been sent to glorify Him and reveal who He is in me. Now You are going to have to teach me how to worship. You are going to have to glorify Him in me and teach me how to worship."

He did.

The first thing He taught me was protocol. When you enter the presence of a king, there is protocol. Some protocol says do not look him in the eyes until you are spoken to; then you can look up. Some says you must come with a gift.

The protocol when you enter Jesus' presence for the Holy Spirit to reveal Him is that there is only one thing He really wants you to offer. You do not have anything else He wants except you. You are it. You are the protocol. You are the gift He wants offered up.

I said, "Okay. I enter Your presence, and I am going to worship You. What part of me do I worship Him with?"

With my physical man, I contact physical things. With my soul, I contact my fellow man through accumulated knowledge. I have fellowship with you through accumulated knowledge. I make contact with you: "Hi, how are you doing?"

If I am going to worship God, it will have to be through accumulated knowledge, with words such as, "I love You." I have to choose words in the language that express this. So now I am going to offer my soul up.

With my soul, I make contact with my fellow man. But now, because I am entering into private worship, I must make contact with God. With my spirit I touch God. In fact, your desires are generally what pull Him in.

I must have been a godfather at least two hundred times. The maternal desire is very strong in a woman and passes most physical bounds. When they say, "Would you pray for me that I can have children? The doctors said I could not," it is easy to pray because Jesus said, "What things soever ye desire, when ye pray, believe that ye receive them, and ye shall have them." They have no problem in the desire area.

Your desire is what pulls Him in. You could say to the mountain, "Be removed and cast into the sea," and if you doubt not in your heart, you will have what you say with your mouth. Doubt not where? In your heart. What things soever you desire when you pray, believing, you shall receive.

I touch God with my spirit, but my desires pull Him in. I can tell when a person has made it to a certain place of desire. Normally God could not quite make it, but because of grace, He will get me to get them, then get me to get Him, and bring the two together. His grace trades your weakness for His strength and puts them out on the trail a little ways. It is exciting.

If with my spirit I contact God, yet I am going to tell Him how much I love Him, I am definitely starting out in the soul. He said, "Offer yourself. You are what I want." He was teaching me all this, and I had very little heart knowledge of what it meant. Not like now. That path is opening up.

I decided to give Him protocol. I said, "You want me? You are going to get me, spirit, soul, and body. I am going to worship You in my mind. If it wanders off down the street, I am going to stop worshiping You and go get it."

I would stop a hundred times in ten minutes.

"I love You. I love You."

Then suddenly I would be thinking about some problem. I would stop and say, "I am not going to disrespect You with lip service. I am going to get my mind and bring it back. Pay attention. Respect this presence you are in."

I said, "Holy Spirit, You had better teach me how to glorify Him." I must have done that a hundred times in an hour, probably a thousand, and about wore myself out.

Brother Coker got hold of the instructions and put himself into them until he said, "It got such a ferocious war that I gave up trying to bring my mind back. But the one thing I would not give up on is that I kept worshiping."

Even though it seemed like lip service, he kept saying, "I love You, God. I love You." His mind was somewhere else. His flesh was outrageous. But he would not stop, and it brought him full circle.

So here is an overlay of instruction. It is good if you can do that. But if you cannot, do not stop worshiping Him because you cannot. Stay in there. Keep worshiping Him. After a while your mind will say, "Who is that?"

"That is me. I have never stopped worshiping."

"Aren't you getting tired of this after a couple of hours?"

"That is irrelevant."

After a while, like any confession, your soul is going to be arrested. After a few days and a few months, my mind, my body, everything wore itself out. It said, "I do not have anything else to think about." Then shut up and submit.

When His presence began to come and saturate and stay longer and longer, worship came easier and easier. I remember getting a big cup of hot tea to keep my throat working.

"I love You. I really love You. I worship, praise, and glorify You."

I got that big cup of tea, kicked back, and His presence stayed longer and longer. Time went by. I set the cup down, and what felt like a second later I reached for another sip. It was cold, and I had not been sleeping.

The further you get into Him with your spirit, the more time seems to stand still. Fellowship leaves the soul realm where you started out, and your heart is suspended in His presence. The longer you stay, the higher fellowship, peace, and power are turned up.

Somebody asked, "How do you fasten yourself in His presence when you are saying, 'I love You'?"

If you cannot do it, do not stop. After a while your soul will transform to what it subjects itself to the most. Keep saying out loud, "I love You, Father God. I love You." Eventually you are going to start believing it, and your soul will come in line. It may take a while.

I think I sped things up by going to get my mind, bringing it back, and bringing it under subjection.

Their question was, "What do you think about when you are doing that? How do you suspend your mind?"

This is how I did it. I am very aware of His presence, even when I cannot feel anything. To me, when I make up my mind to come into His presence, it is like there is a Person standing there. I am very aware of it, and I acknowledge Him.

"I love You. I worship You. I glorify You."

I monitor what is going on in my spirit while my overall heart attitude is continually acknowledging His presence.

Somebody said, "Who do you worship the most, the Father or the Son?"

Mostly I worship the Father, and I give gratitude and worship to the Son for paying the price. Yes, I worship Him a lot too.

"Do you ever tell the Holy Spirit you love Him?"

Yes, I do, as I would tell a person. But I do not worship Him; I worship with Him. I tell the Holy Spirit, "I appreciate You. You know how much I love You. Thank You for coming and being so close in my life, teaching me how to worship."

"Jesus, I love You and praise You and glorify You. Father..."

There I become aware of His presence and suspend that. When I start feeling that presence coming, I become aware of that and hold it up. I acknowledge Him in that presence and worship Him and praise Him. If I do not feel anything, I acknowledge Him and His presence there. I do not try to visualize a person or anything. I acknowledge a Being.

It works quite well. That is Him. Hallelujah.